

Jiacheng Kuang

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Research Interests: Textual Analysis in Finance, Managerial Expectation, Empirical Asset Pricing

Education

M.A. in National Economics (Digital Economy and Digital Finance) Sep 2024 – Present
Nanjing University

- Supervisor: Prof. Haitao Huang
- Core Courses: Advanced Econometrics (90), Advanced Microeconomics (88), Advanced Macroeconomics (83), Machine Learning and Data Analysis (92)

B.A. in Finance Sep 2020 – Jun 2024
Wuhan University

- GPA: 3.74/4.0 (Rank: 8/74, Top 10%)
- Core Courses: Investments (93), Corporate Finance (93), Security Investment Analysis (89), Statistics (91), Macroeconomics (90), Microeconomics (90)

Working Papers

1. Decoding Managerial Beliefs from Corporate Disclosure: Measuring Expectation Divergence with LLMs, (with Zhenyu Gao and Haitao Huang) April 2026
Present at: CICF 2026 (Scheduled); Greater China Area Finance Conference 2026 (Scheduled); MRS International Risk Conference 2026 (Scheduled); Annual Graduate Economics Academic Conference 2026(Second Best Paper Award); TONGJI University 2026; Nanjing University 2025

- **Metric Construction:** Constructed a novel “Firm Expectation Divergence” index by leveraging Large Language Models (LLMs) to extract structured beliefs from 41,000+ MD&A texts (2012–2024), effectively distinguishing rational expectations from emotional sentiment.
- **Empirical Findings:** Documented a “Dual Anomaly”: high divergence predicts deteriorating future fundamentals (ROA/ROE) due to managerial information processing defects, yet positively predicts risk-adjusted stock returns (Alpha).
- **Mechanism:** Validated the “Risk Premium Channel”, showing that divergence proxies for idiosyncratic risk and information uncertainty, compelling rational investors to demand higher compensation.
- **Robustness:** Confirmed robustness by controlling for Economic Policy Uncertainty (EPU) and traditional textual sentiment, proving the metric captures incremental cognitive information.

2. Managerial Attention Allocation and Industry Rotation: Evidence from Textual Analysis, work in Progress Jan 2026 – Present

- **Motivation:** Motivated by the distinct sector rotation characteristics of China’s A-share market, this study investigates whether fund managers possess “industry attention alpha”. It focuses on

specific industry attention allocation, examining if managers can generate excess returns by anticipating sector shifts.

- **Methodology:** Trained Word2Vec models to expand industry-specific keyword dictionaries based on Shenwan classifications; constructed novel metrics including Attention Crowding Index (ACI) and Leading Attention Index (LAI) from fund managers' outlook sections.
- **Preliminary Findings:** Documented that aggregated attention crowding significantly leads market index performance (CSI 300); managers with higher LAI (predictive attention) generate superior future returns, whereas deviating from consensus (ADC) is associated with underperformance.

Research Experience

1. CUHK Summer Research Mentorship Program Jul 2026 – Aug 2026 (Scheduled)
Research Assistant Supervisor: Prof. Zhenyu Gao (CUHK)

2. Policy in the Eye of the Analyst Mar 2026 – Jun 2026
Research Assistant Supervisor: Prof. Pengfei Sui (CUHK-Shenzhen)

- **Data Construction:** Choice analyst report database: ~267,731 reports from 1,607 institutions covering 2017–2025. Policy database from PKULAW: ~970,000 policies covering 2000–2025.
- **Disagreement Measure:** Using LLMs, we decompose analysts' policy reasoning in industry reports into distinct dimensions. We compute the heterogeneous belief (disagreement) that exists among analysts covering the same industry after the same policy shock.

3. Spillover Effects of U.S. Monetary Policy on Chinese Banking Systemic Risk Feb 2024 – Jun 2024

Research Assistant Supervisor: Prof. He Nie (Wuhan University)

- **Data Construction:** Constructed a cross-border macro-financial dataset by integrating FRED and Wind/CSMAR databases; performed rigorous data cleaning and outlier processing.
- **Empirical Analysis:** Assisted in implementing Vector Autoregression (VAR) models in MATLAB; analyzed dynamic transmission mechanisms via Impulse Response Functions (IRF) and Variance Decomposition.
- **Literature Review:** Synthesized classic literature on cross-border monetary policy spillovers to support the feasibility analysis section of the research grant proposal.

Conference Participation

- The 2026 MRS International Risk Conference (Scheduled) Jul 2026
- The China International Conference in Finance (CICF 2026) (Scheduled) Jun 2026
- The 6th Greater China Area Finance Conference (GCFC 2026) (Scheduled) Jun 2026
- The 12th Annual Graduate Economics Academic Conference Jun 2026
- The 19th Annual Academic Conference of Jiangsu Federation of Social Sciences Nov 2025
- The 2025 MRS International Risk Conference Jul 2025

Industry Experience

CITIC Securities

Aug 2023 – Nov 2023

Research Department Intern

Selected Competitions

- China Post-Graduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling (National Second Prize, Top 2%) Nov 2025
- China Undergraduate EE Mathematical Modeling Competition (National Third Prize) Jul 2023
- China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling (CUMCM)(Provincial First Prize) Nov 2022
- National University Commercial Elite Challenge (National Second Prize) Oct 2022

Honors & Awards

- Outstanding Graduate Student, Nanjing University Nov 2025
- First-Class Scholarship, Nanjing University ×2 Dec 2024, Dec 2025

Skills

Programming: Python, Stata, MATLAB, R

AI Coding Tool: Claude Code, Codex

Languages: English (CET-6)

References

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